genetic ge · net · ic

Advanced Definition

adjective

1. of or concerning the science of heredity.
2. of, concerning, caused by, or influenced by heredity, esp. by genes.

   genetic engineering

3. of or concerning the beginning or origin of something.

Spanish cognate

genético: The Spanish word *genético* means genetic.

These are some examples of how the word or forms of the word are used:

1. The researchers injected muscle tissue with tiny pieces of genetic material. That material transformed the muscles into factories of proteins that attack viruses.
2. Sexual reproduction results in genetically new offspring from the fusion of male and female sex cells. Humans reproduce sexually and their offspring are genetically a combination of their parents' features and DNA.
3. It's a complex lottery in which offspring of the first two organisms inherits a combination of their genetic material. The possible variations inherent in recombining the parents' DNA is very, very broad—larger than the pool of entries in the state lotto jackpot!
4. In the United States, NPC is relatively rare, occurring in just seven of every 1 million Americans. NPC has a strong genetic component, explains Costantino, which is why the cancer is more common in Southeast Asia and among immigrant families from that region.
5. Trees that have been genetically modified need approval from the government before they can be planted in the wild. The scientists doing genetic modification defend their work. They point out that there are around 45,000 genes in the chestnut tree, and the researchers are adding one-to-three additional genes.
6. "Our population and our use of the finite resources of Planet Earth are growing exponentially, along with our technical ability to change the environment for good or ill. But our genetic code still carries the selfish and aggressive instincts that were of survival advantage in the past.
7. Schweitzer uncovered ancient blood vessels and some red blood cells from the dinosaur. Schweitzer said that new techniques might make it possible for scientists to one day extract a dinosaur's genetic material. Genetic material determines an animal's inherited characteristics, such as eye color and hair color.
8. Genetic engineering has been going on for years. In fact, much of today's packaged food contains genetically engineered corn or soy. Still, many people are suspicious of genetic engineering. The environmental organization Greenpeace, for instance, likens transgenic organisms to "a giant genetic experiment" that could have unforeseen consequences for the environment and for human health.
9. Breeding has everything to do with genetics. Every living creature has genes, which is basically a code inside of the body that

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determines how you look and to an extent, act. Your genes determine how tall you grow, what color hair you have, and how quickly your skin gets sunburnt. Our genes are inherited from our parents, which is why you see family resemblance between parents, children and siblings.

10. Often, animals' genetic mutations can help the process of selective breeding. The Belgian Blue, for instance, is an unusually muscular cow; it contains something called the double muscling gene. A muscular cow is valuable for the amount of meat found on its frame. A few hundred years ago, farmers capitalized on this particular cow's muscle mass by trying to breed more of them. Over time, and with effort, a new breed of muscular cow was born.

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